

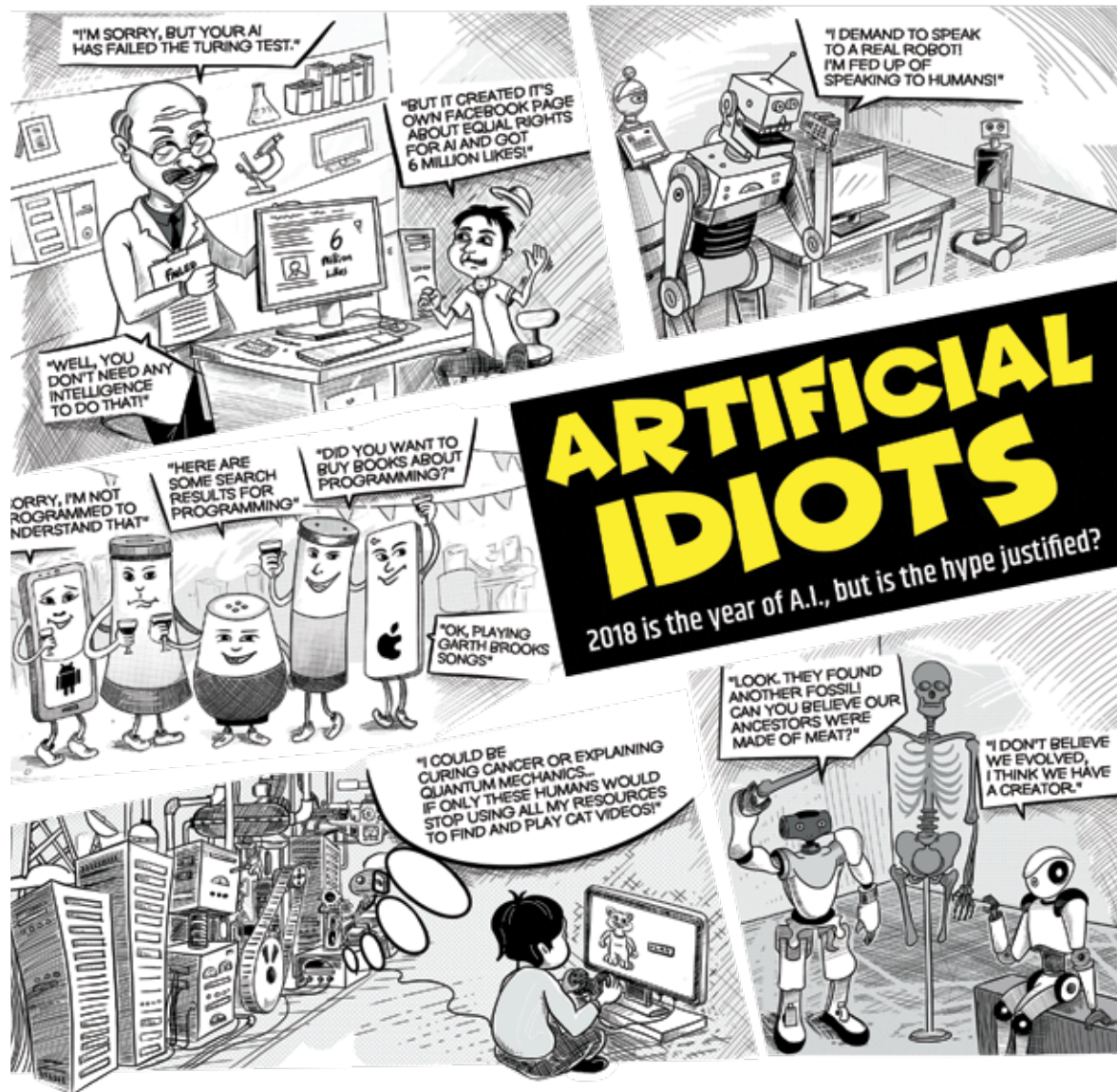


Illustration: Peterson PJ

We know 2018 has only just begun, but mark our words, you're going to hear a heck of a lot of companies use the word "AI" to promote everything they do. In fact, it's our prediction for 2018 that AI will be the tech buzzword that drowns out all others, by a mile! Forget iPhone 11 (X!), forget Android, and forget any phone of any type... the only thing you will remember about the phones of this year in 2019 will be if they claimed their assistant was AI, or at least more AI than before... or something to do with AI.

With all the AI blitzkrieg that's expected, especially by marketing gurus who are paid million dollar salaries to make you part with your thousands in savings, it's obvious that we need to step in, and put things in perspective for you. As usual, we don't want you falling for all the hype, but at the same time, we want to keep you in-

formed of some amazing developments that you won't hear about, because they're being achieved by people who don't have products to sell you (not yet at least).

Thus, in order to cover AI exhaustively, from every conceivable yet relevant angle, it became important to set it as our cover story to kick off 2018. We're going to look at everything from what AI is, to what is isn't (despite claims by companies to the contrary), what will AI do for India, and whether it will screw us out of jobs, can AI ever be "created", and what kind of hardware will be needed to run the AI of the future.

While we want you to sit back and enjoy this rather long read ahead, we do hope you will lean forwards once it's done and send us your thoughts on the subject. As always, write in to editor@digit.in with feedback.

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